

You need not use the 'Advanced' window as you will need to know the nuances of the firewall and also have a bit of networking knowledge to be able to safely play around. Without proper precautions and with improper settings, you will not be able to connect to the Internet.

Click 'OK' to exit this window and restart the computer if needed. You are done configuring the firewall.



Windows XP SP2 Security Center
resources screen

There is other free firewall software also available on the Internet such as BlackIce, Kerio Personal firewall, Kaspersky, F-Secure and many more. You could use any of these if you wish. We chose ZoneAlarm since it is the most-used free firewall software across the world.

There are other also other paid software such as Norton and McAfee who have firewall software. These are more customisable and you also get professional technical support, which may be absent in case of the free software. But whatever the software, remember that to browse the Internet safely, a good firewall is, these days, a must!